Table of Contents

iMotions Online > iMotions Online Study Pages

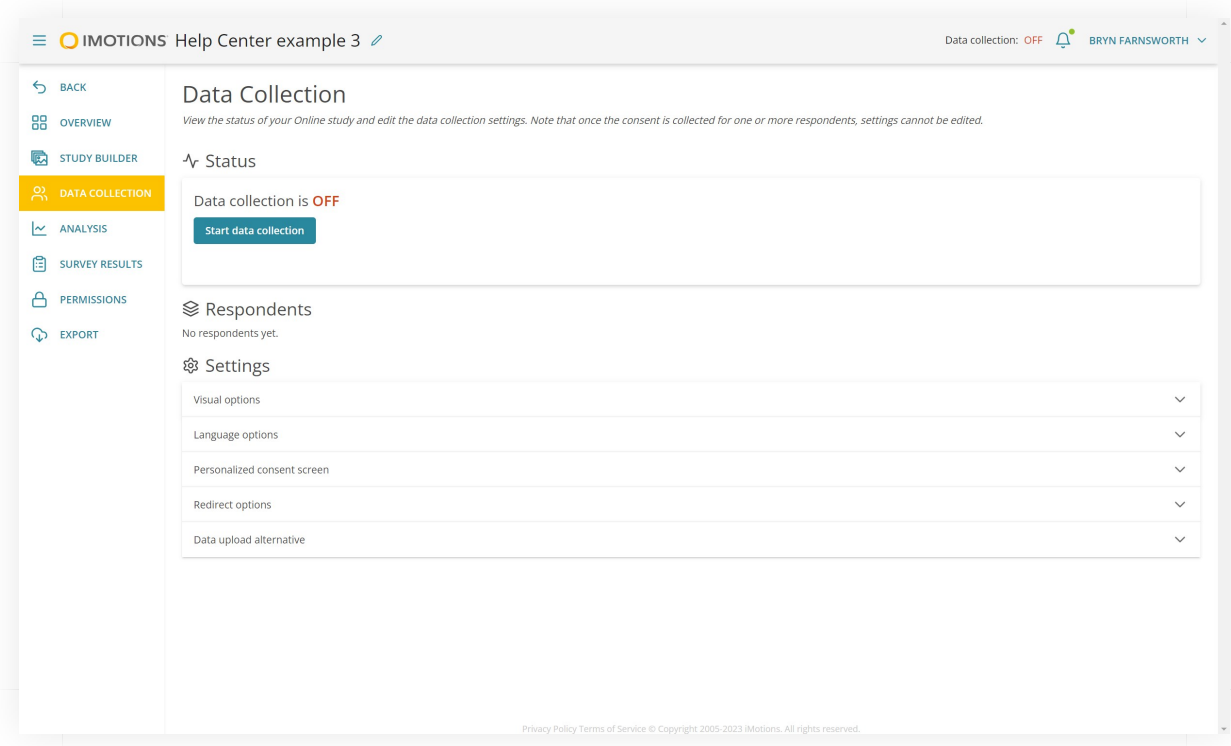
Data collection - iMotions Online 2

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

Data collection - iMotions Online

This article explains each of the features associated with the data collection page on iMotions Online.

When you first enter the data collection page, you will be presented with the following screen:



Center: The center of the screen shows three sections, each of which are elaborated upon in the sections below - Status, Respondents, Settings.

Top: Along the very top of the screen, you can see the study title, which can be changed by clicking on the pencil icon next to it. You can also see whether or not data collection is live (i.e. if a link to study participants is active). You can also access account information, and submit feedback, by clicking on your name in the top right.

Left side: On the left you are able to navigate through other study sections. Each of these are explained in detail within the following articles: Study builder, Analysis, Survey results, and Export.

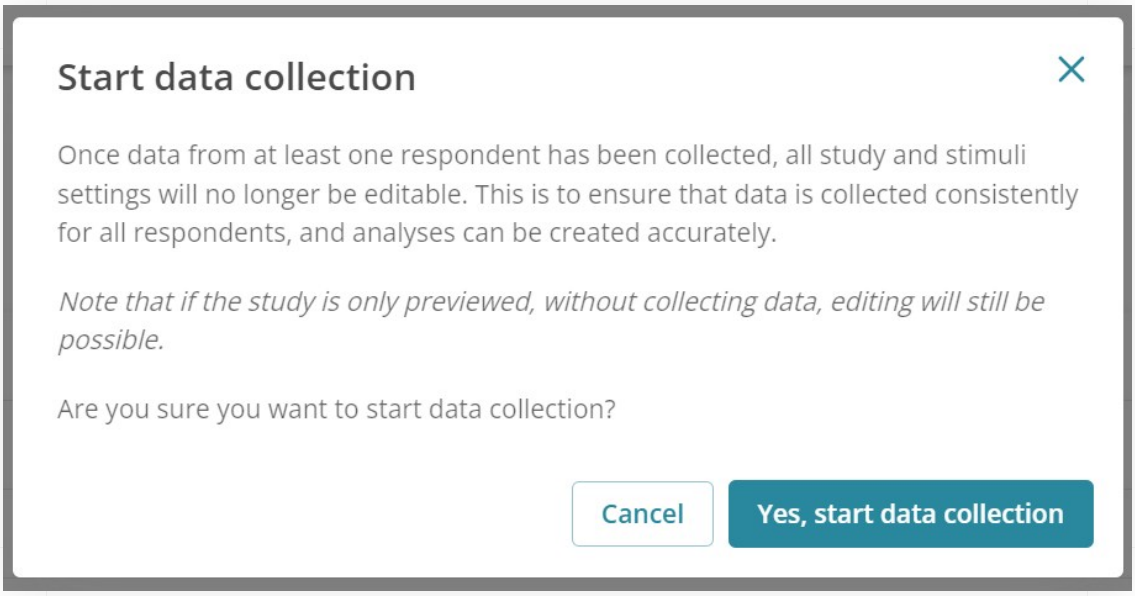
Status

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

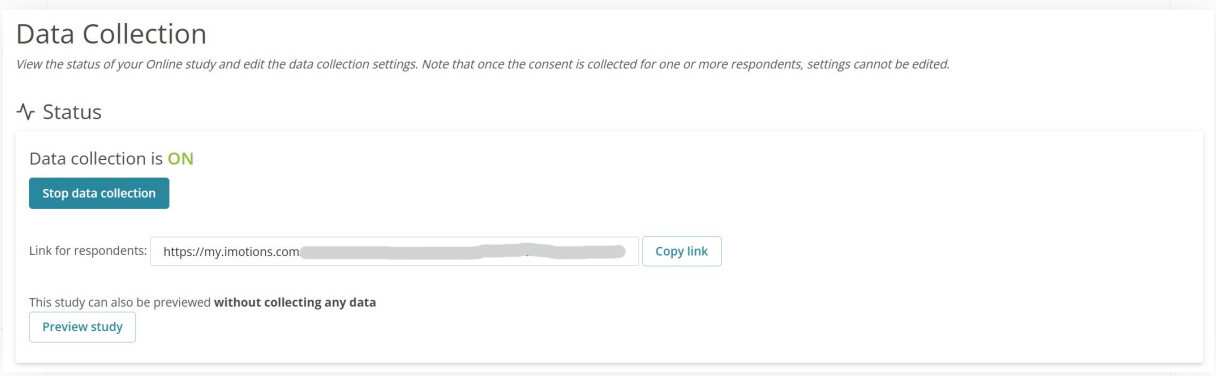
If this is the first time you are encountering this page, then the data collection will be set to "off". Clicking on the "start data collection" button means that the link to the study can be shared, and data collection can begin. Participants with the link will be able to take part in the study, and have their data collected. Please ensure that you have looked through all stimuli and study settings before starting data collection. Once you have collected data from one or more participant(s), you will not be able to apply any further edits to the study or stimuli settings.

It is recommended that you check your stimuli settings on the study builder page, and go through the study settings to confirm that all settings are as intended before sharing the study link. Note that it will still be possible to preview the study, and make any changes as needed, as long as no actual data collection takes place (with the exception of the study language - this must be changed before data collection is live). This means that you should not share the study link until you are certain that all changes are final.

Once you click on "start data collection", you will be presented with the following window:



Clicking on "Yes, start data collection" will turn on data collection, and enable a link that can be used for sharing your study with participants.



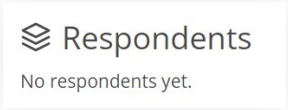
Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

From here you can copy the link for distribution, or preview the study without collecting any data.

Note that the link from the "Preview study" button can also be shared with others without collecting any data, if you have collaborators who you would like to also preview the study before data is collected.

Respondents

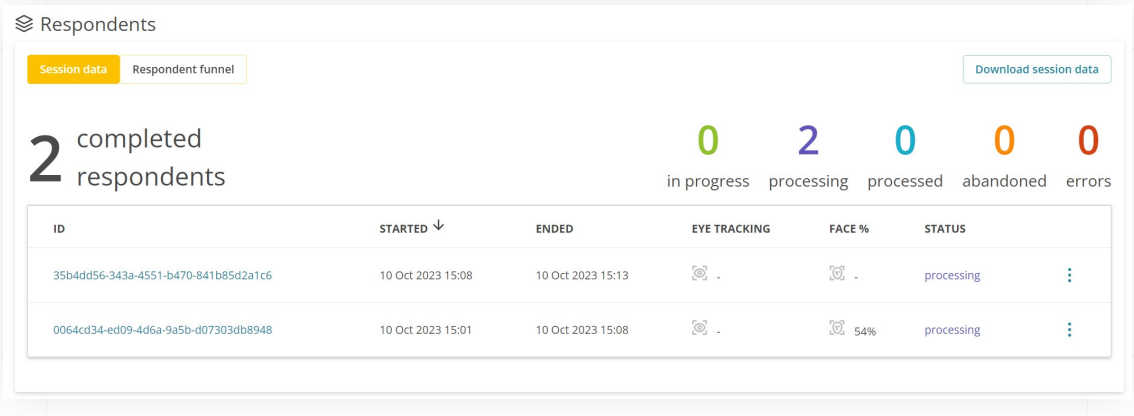
The respondents section will simply state "No respondents yet." until participant data is collected.



Session data

Upon data collection, the screen will show the "Session data" - the number of participants who have completed the study (shown here as "2 completed respondents"). The screen also shows:

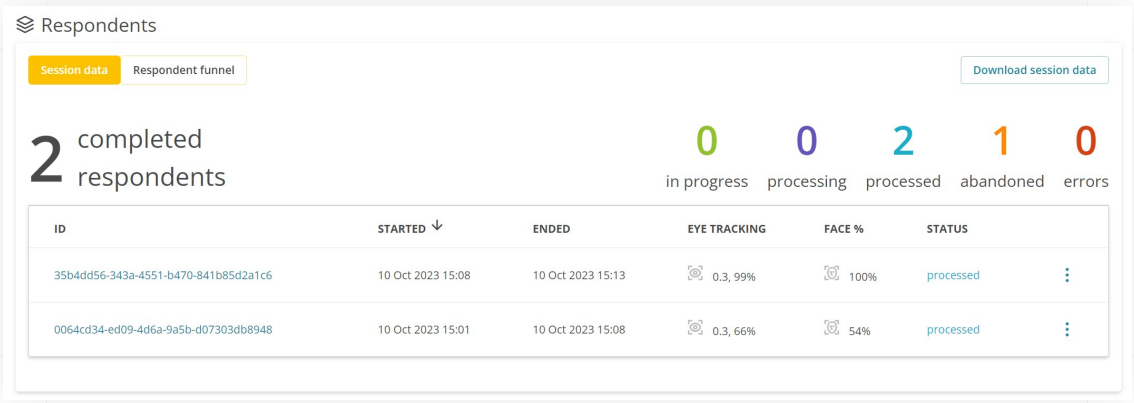
- The number of participants who are currently in progress with the study.
- The number of participants whose data are undergoing processing.
- The number of participants who have had their data successfully processed.
- The number of participants who abandoned the study.
- The number of errors that occurred with data collection.



It's possible to download all of the session data as a .csv file by clicking on "download session data". From here it's also possible to see when data collection began and ended for each participant. Each participant ID can also be clicked on - the details shown there are explained further in the study session data section below.

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

Once the data has been processed, the eye tracking and face % columns provide numbers related to the quality and amount of the collected data. In short, the percentages show the relative amount of time for which eye tracking or facial expression data was collected. The decimal numbers under the eye tracking column (0.3 for both participants in the image below) pertain to the quality of the data collected, with lower numbers related to higher data quality. More detail is provided in the box below.



Data quality

The first data point under eye tracking (0.3 in the image above) pertains to the eye tracking accuracy score. This is the mean distance between the actual and expected gaze positions calculated during calibration. This distance is measured in visual degrees, with the smaller number meaning more accuracy. Visual degrees is calculated as the angle of the straight lines from the outer edges of the stimulus to the participant's eye (see an example image here). We recommend a threshold of 3.0.

The next data point under eye tracking (99% and 66% in the image above) pertains to the eye tracking data quality. This is calculated as the ratio of valid eye tracking samples in relation to the total number of samples collected. For example, if a 1000 samples are collected, but only 800 of them are valid (i.e. where the eyes could be detected as looking at the screen), then the data quality will be 80%. The larger the number, the better the quality. We recommend a quality score of at least 90%.

The data point under "face %" pertains to facial expression analysis data quality. This is calculated as the ratio of valid samples (where the face can be detected) in relation to the total number of samples collected. The larger the number, the better the quality. We recommend a quality score of at least 80%.

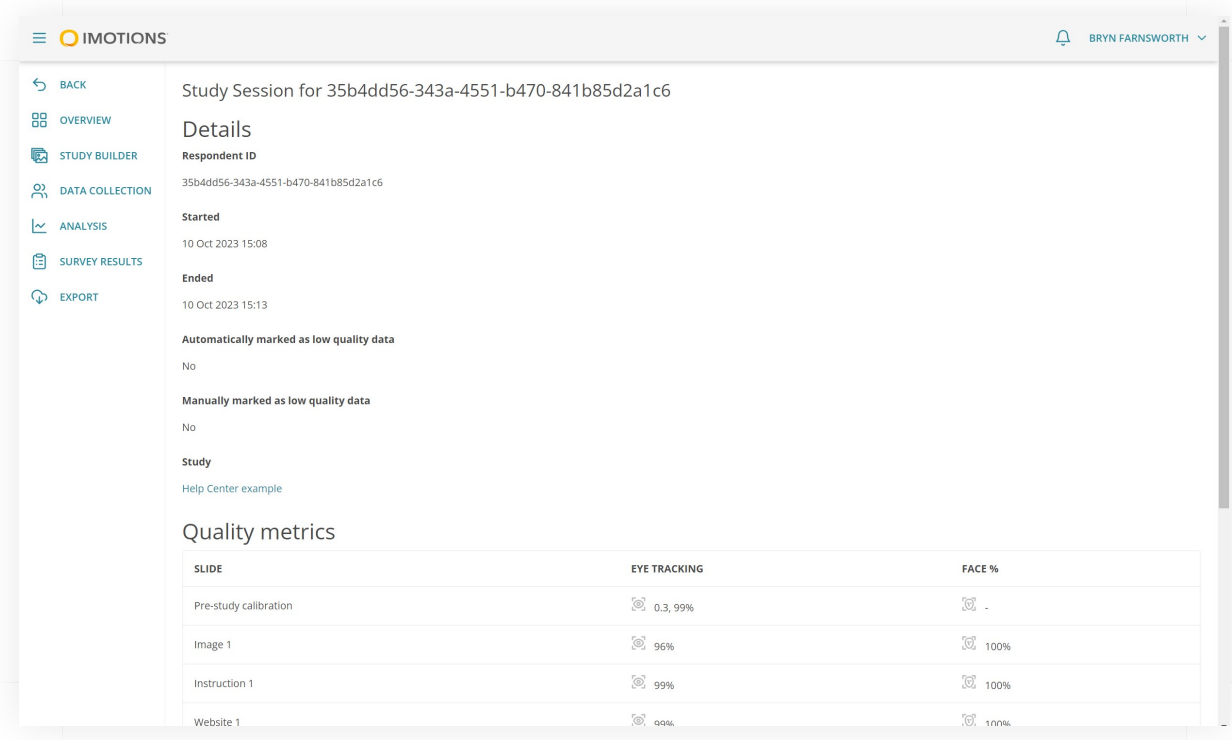
The current status (in progress, processing, processed, abandoned, or error) of each is also shown under "status". By clicking on the three dots on the right, it's possible to delete the specific participants dataset.

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

It's also possible to click on each participant ID (the long alphanumerical sequence shown on the left of the image above) to view more information about each participant. This will lead to the study session data page for that specific participant.

Study session data

Once you have clicked on a specific participant ID, you will be presented with the study session data page. This shows detailed information regarding the start and end time of the experiment. It also shows whether or not the participant was automatically or manually marked as having low quality data. It also provides a link to the study itself (under "Study").

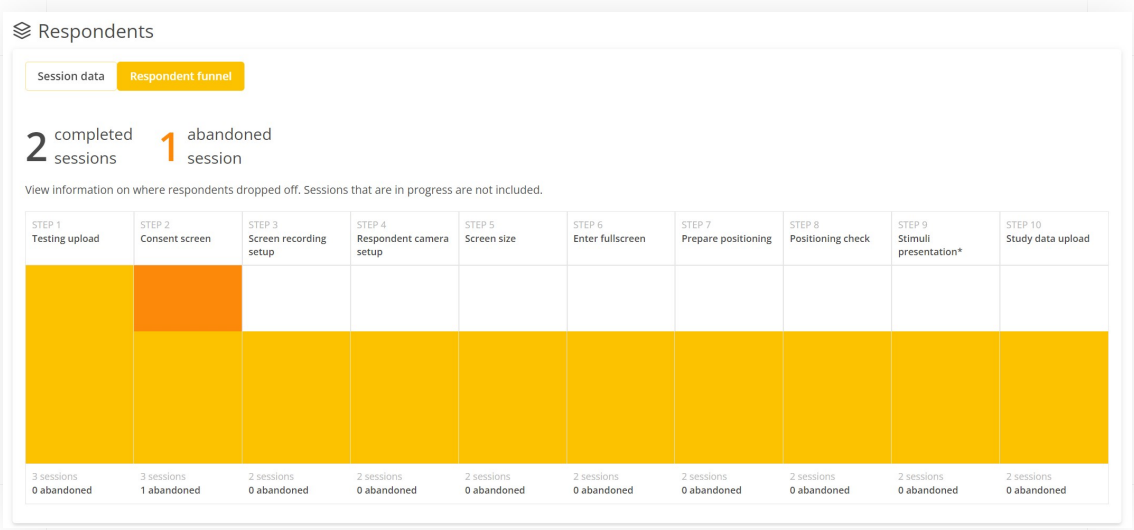


The "Quality metrics" table provides an overview of eye tracking and facial expression analysis data quality for each stimulus, for this specific participant. An overall average value is also provided at the bottom of the table. A red outlined box at the bottom of the page provides the possibility to delete this specific data.

Respondent funnel

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

This tab provides an overview of participant progression through the study. Light orange colors show where the participant successfully completed the study steps. The darker orange shows where the participant abandoned the study (this could be intentional or through an interrupted internet connection). This information may be useful if you are finding that many participants are abandoning the study - it's then possible to see if a specific part which causes the most abandonment, and address the issue accordingly.



Settings

The settings section here covers all alterable elements surrounding the study. Here you will find visual options, language options, the personalized consent screen options, redirect options, and the data upload alternative. Each of these are covered in the sections below.

Visual options

The visual options allow you to define the number of checks made to ensure optimal data quality. Each of these options should be considered as part of a balance in ensuring optimal data quality, and brevity / ease for participants, which can have an impact on the number of participants who complete the study. Your precise study needs will determine the options you choose based on this tradeoff.

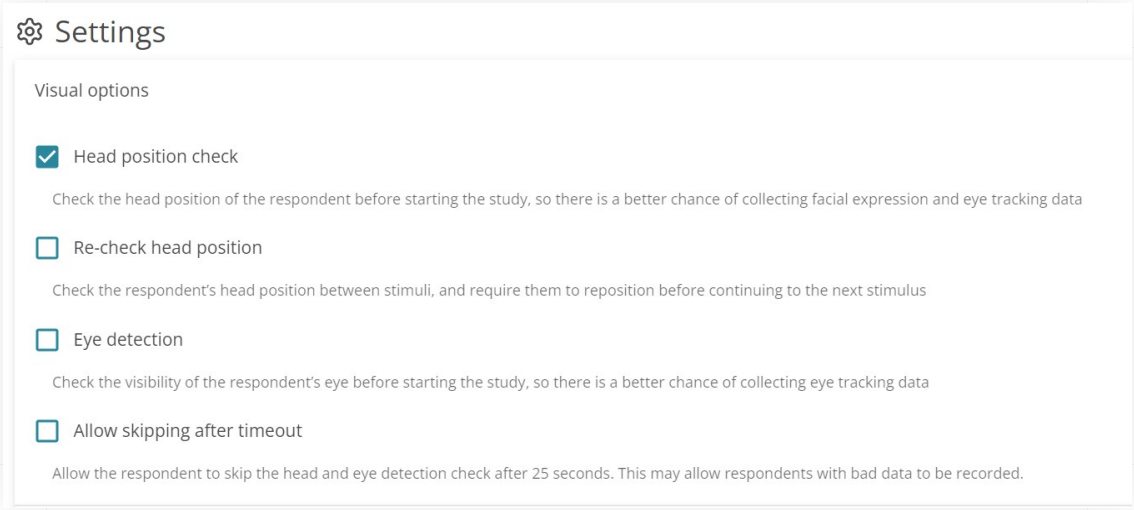
Head position check: If enabled, ensures that the participant's head is in the appropriate position (i.e. facing the screen) before start the study. This check will only apply prior to the study starting.

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

Re-check head position: If enabled, checks if the head position has been changed in between each stimulus exposure. This adds more time and complexity to the study but increases the likelihood of collecting optimal data. Only possible to enable if the head position check is enabled.

Eye detection: If enabled, checks if the participant's eyes are visible, prior to the study start.

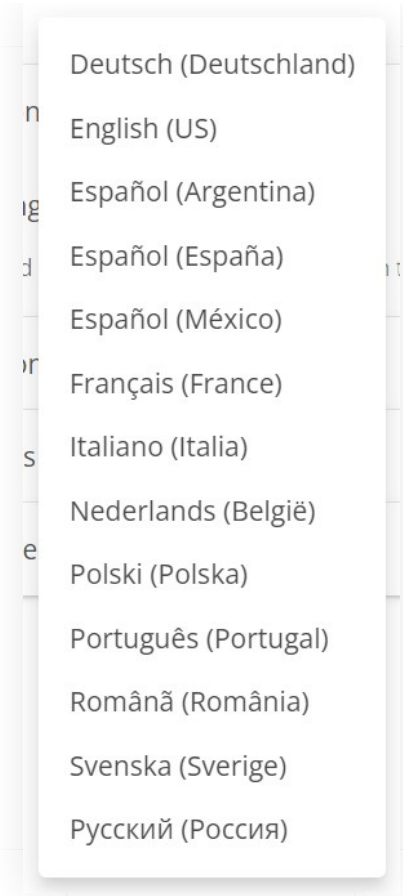
Allow skipping after timeout: If enabled, the participant is able to start the study after a detection check of 25 seconds without a successful detection of the head or eyes. Only possible to enable if the head position check or eye detection are enabled.



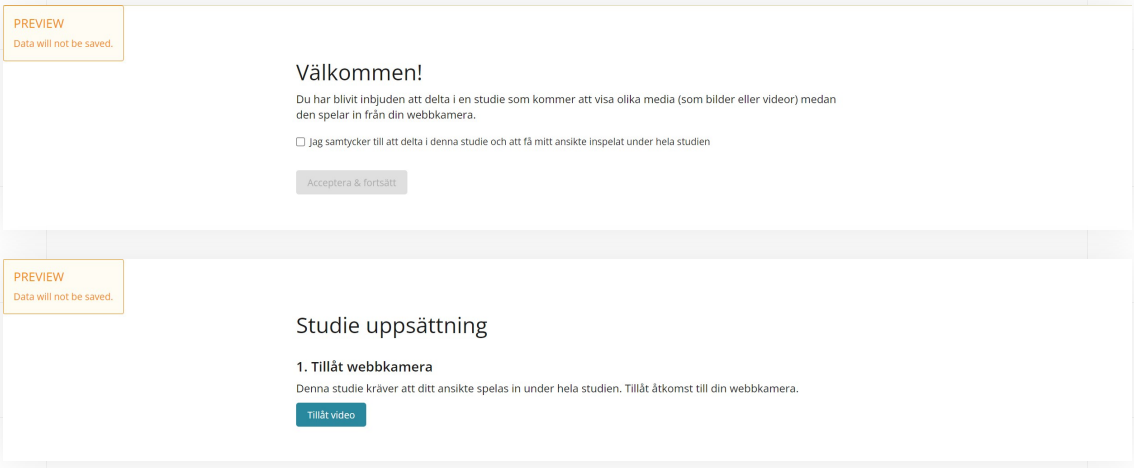
Language options

From here you can change the language that the participant instructions and consent screen are displayed in. This will not change the language of any stimuli included in your study. Currently iMotions Online offers 13 languages. Please reach out to us if you require a language not included on the list. Please note that the study language is defaulted to US English. If changes are required, a new language must be changed before data collection is set to "on".

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions



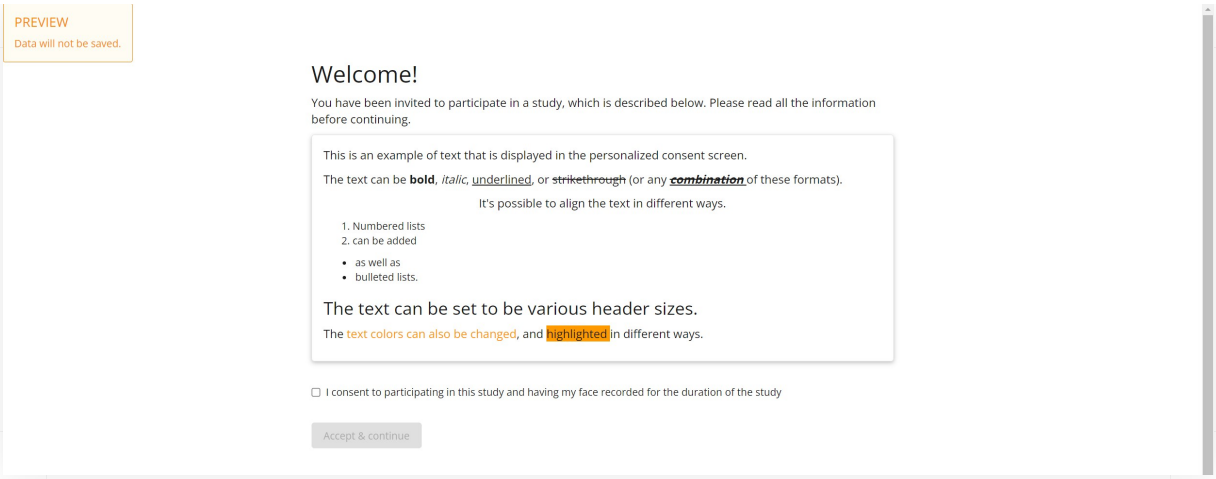
The first two screen that the participant sees are shown in Swedish below as examples.



Personalized consent screen

It is possible to add your own personalized consent screen that is displayed on the very first screen that the participant sees after clicking the link. The text is displayed within a box and can be created in a rich text editor. Click the checkbox and create (or copy over) the text you wish to use.

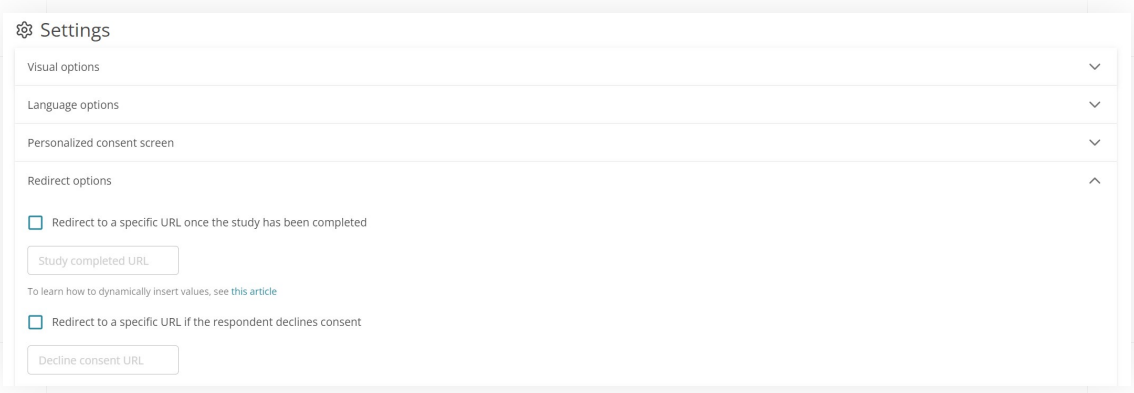
Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions



Redirect options

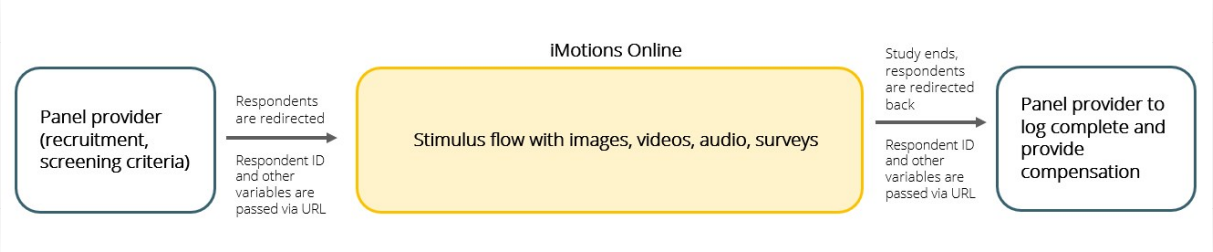
The options here allow you to add a specific URL that the participants will be redirected to once the study is complete, or if the participant declines consent at the beginning of the study. These are often used in two ways - as a portal for further information, or for working with panel providers.

As a portal for more information: This allows you to guide participants to webpages that can, for example, provide further information about the goals of the study. Alternatively, the URL for declined consent could lead to a page that thanks participants for their time.



For use with panel providers: These URL parameters also allow you to work with panel providers. Typically, a panel provider will handle recruitment of respondents, then will forward an iMotions study URL to the respondents that have passed the screening criteria. After the respondents are finished with the iMotions study, they are usually redirected to an outside URL to log study completion and/or provide compensation. For this workflow to be successful, iMotions Online must "handshake" with the panel provider such that information on each participant is passed from one platform to another. One such example is the passthrough of respondent IDs, as described in the figure below.

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions



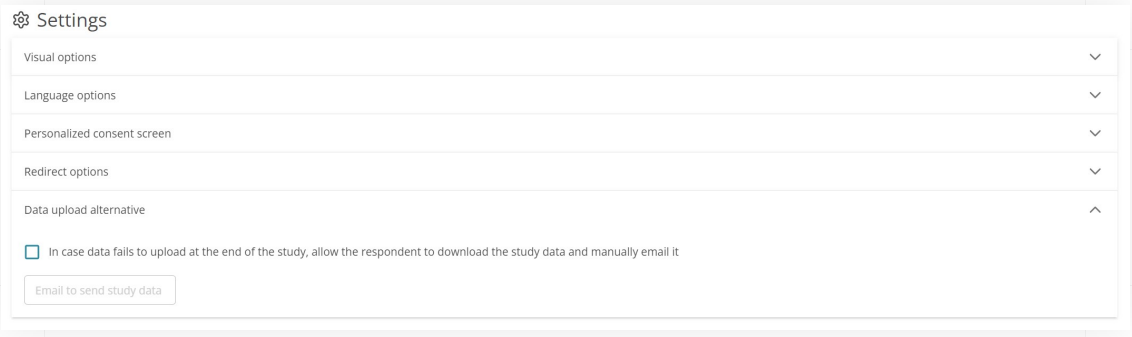
Cross communications with iMotions Online can occur in two ways - by receiving and / or sending information. iMotions Online allows cross-communication with external websites using the HTTP GET method. The HTTP GET Method depends on queries appended to the end of a URL in a specific manner.

For example, iMotions will automatically append any query parameters that were given *before* the study. Let's use the example of "www.panelprovider.com/mystudycompletion" being entered in the redirect after completion URL box. If participants enter the iMotions study with the HTTP GET queries "subjectID=Jessica&favoritefood=noodles" entered from the panel provider, once the participant has completed the study they will automatically be redirected to "www.panelprovider.com/mystudycompletion?subjectID=Jessica&favoritefood=noodles".

More information about the HTTP GET Method, the corresponding tokens, and the overall process is detailed in the article: Using iMotions Online with a panel provider.

Data upload alternative

As with any operation on the internet, there is always the possibility that connection issues will interrupt the planned flow of information. Ticking this checkbox will provide the participant with the option to download their data, and to manually email it to the researcher. You can enter your email with which you wish to receive any manually sent study data.

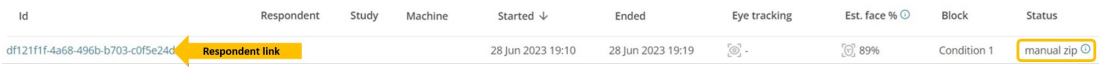


Manually Uploading Respondent Data Files to my.imotions.com

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

For iMotions Online studies using the *Data upload alternative* option, respondents will be able to download their data files (zip file) and send them to the specified email address (in study settings on my.imotions.com). The downloaded file can be uploaded manually on the Data Collection page for your study on my.imotions.com.

1. Log in to my.imotions.com and select the study and respondent that requires manual upload. This is indicated by the Respondent Status: *manual zip.*



2. Click on *Upload respondent zip file* and select the respondent data file.



3. Once the upload is complete, the data will begin processing.

Powered by Document360

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions

Confidential © 2023 Redistribution is not permitted without written permission from iMotions